

Name: Canane, Christine Mae C.

Section: PM

Subject: Information Assurance and Security 2 (IAS2)

Date: June 1, 2026

Protecting Information and Improving Data Security

Information security plays a vital role in today's digital world because almost every activity depends on technology and digital information. Individuals use online platforms for communication, banking, shopping, and education, while organizations rely on information systems to manage operations and store important data. Because of this dependence on technology, protecting information from unauthorized access, misuse, and cyberattacks has become a major responsibility for both users and IT professionals.

One of the most common threats to digital information is cybercrime. Cybercriminals use various methods such as phishing attacks, malware, ransomware, hacking, and identity theft to gain access to sensitive information. For example, phishing emails often trick users into revealing passwords or financial details, while malware can damage systems and steal confidential data. Data breaches may also expose personal and organizational information, leading to financial losses, reputational damage, and privacy violations.

To protect sensitive information, individuals and organizations must adopt effective cybersecurity practices. Strong passwords, multi-factor authentication, regular software updates, and secure backups are important measures that help reduce security risks. Organizations should also implement data encryption, firewalls, antivirus software, and network security controls to safeguard information from unauthorized access. In addition, cybersecurity awareness programs are essential because human error remains one of the leading causes of security incidents. Educating users about online threats can significantly reduce the likelihood of successful cyberattacks.

As an aspiring IT graduate, I believe that IT professionals have a critical responsibility in maintaining cybersecurity and protecting digital assets. They must ensure that systems are secure, monitor networks for suspicious activities, identify vulnerabilities, and respond quickly to security incidents. IT professionals should also follow ethical standards and respect data privacy while developing and managing information systems. Their role extends beyond

technical tasks because they are responsible for building trust between organizations and the people who depend on secure digital services.

In my observation, cybersecurity should not be viewed solely as a technical issue but as a shared responsibility among individuals, organizations, and technology professionals. As cyber threats continue to evolve, stronger security policies, continuous user education, and the adoption of emerging cybersecurity technologies such as Artificial Intelligence and advanced threat detection systems will become increasingly important. By combining technology, awareness, and responsible practices, society can create a safer digital environment and better protect valuable information from cyber threats.